astute captain. Brad Haddin was a nuggety batsman who led several significant fightbacks when our bowlers, principally Stuart Broad, were on a roll. Some of the sledging was below the belt but I enjoyed a beer with them once it was all over. They're very similar to us, beneath a different badge.

We were in trouble, almost from the get-go, and fell apart under pressure. So many things went wrong. It all came to a natural end, with bewildering speed. Andy Flower had become jaded by the incessant demands of international coaching. Chris Tremlett struggled badly and was dropped after the first Test. Steven Finn lost his rhythm and confidence.

Monty Panesar was at his most enigmatic. His form was so unpredictable he could not be trusted. He was, on his own admission, on the rebound from alcohol problems, and withdrew into himself. He seemed especially troubled by Trotty's issues, and later sought medical advice after suffering anxiety and paranoia that stemmed from a loss of confidence and self-esteem.

He hadn't reached out to the group, and you do worry about someone you don't see on tour. I tried to coax him out of his room but, to be honest, he was erratic. Was his self-containment a necessary shield we had taken away briefly, albeit for all the right reasons? All I know is his decline was sad, and deeply affecting.

He had quickly become a cult figure on coming into the England team. He bowled beautifully, with a lovely shape on the ball, massive hands, great control, a very repeatable action. A couple of steps in, arms up, good pace. His skill was just to bowl the same ball, one after the other. He held an end up, and rarely bowled a bad delivery.

Whenever he fielded the ball, he received a huge cheer. He worked very hard on his batting and would get a standing ovation for a forward defensive. He had a loveable simplicity in that he knew about little else than bowling and Sikhism. Were people laughing with him or at him? Did his exposure, as one of the most recognizable figures in the country, exacerbate underlying problems? Was he ready for the pressure, the scrutiny, the expectation, the celebrity, the fame? There were, for the time being, more questions than answers.

Swanny came to me, admitting that he expected to be dropped in favour of Monty after bowling poorly in the second-Test defeat at Adelaide. I asked him, as one of my senior lieutenants, to help generate the energy we